

HOME ENTERTAINMENT



Optical media

With optical media came digitization and a revolution in the way that content was viewed by end users. Optical media differed greatly from previous Analog media types such as magnetic tapes and vinyl records. The playback from a compact disk or DVD does not degrade in quality depending on the number of times it's been played, unlike its predecessors. The other factor that led to a revolution of sorts was the quantum leaps optical media made in terms of data storage capacity. Today a dual layer Blu-ray disk can store upto 50GB of data - an amount unimaginable about a decade ago. These vast fields of storage enabled encoding of high definition content and multiple channel sound amongst other things, taking the Home Entertainment experience to stratospheric levels.



Minato, Tokyo

One of the 23 wards in Tokyo city, this place is the headquarters of the corporation that gave us

Blu-ray technology, DVCAM standard, among many others. Yes we are talking of Sony corporation. And Sony is just one out of the 49 such conglomerates headquartered in Minato which also happens to have an insane density of over 10,000 people per square kilometre.



Virtual Reality

Within the realm of immersive technology at home, the sort of holy grail to reach for has always been Virtual Reality. All technologies used in home entertainment today - right from things like stereoscopic 3D displays to synced ambient lighting - all have one goal: to immerse you further into the

content that you're watching. To try and appease all your senses innovators have come up with ways to tingle previously untapped senses such as your sense of smell. Another home entertainment system blows hot air at you synced and co-ordinated with explosions in the movie that you're watching. But the next step would be directly feeding your brain - the controller of all your senses - virtual experiences.



Quit while you're ahead

So you've got yourself a killer AV set up at home. Highend receiver, floor standers, Blu-ray player and all the works. You call your friends over and are blown away by the high octane thrills your latest blockbuster Blu-ray is able to unleash. You kick back with the Playstation 3 until your friends decide to call it a night. In a few months though there seems to be something amiss. Soon you notice that you're spending more and more time at home, slowly detaching from the world. You're so immersed in your high definition world that the real world starts losing definition. This is what we call Entertainment Addiction Syndrome (EAS). The only known cure is to read technology magazines.



28 @ \$5,000

The number of speakers that comprise the "Wall of sound", a massive iPod dock, literally as large as a small wall, boasting of an output power of 120W RMS and costing \$5,000.



Red One

Red One
Red Digital
camera company

is a renowned name in digital cinematography and Red One was their first camera produced in 2006. It has an 11.5 MP bayer pattern CCD sensor and is capable of shooting at a 4.5k resolution at 30 FPS. This is way beyond HD which is 1080p and with 4K resolution TVs coming in the near future, a lot of pure 4K content will be made by such cameras. Last year's blockbuster 'The Social Network' was shot completely on a Red One camera.



Yoon Woo Lee

The 65-year-old Vice Chairman of Samsung Electronics Co., Ltd. joined Samsung in 1968 and was appointed president of Samsung's Semiconductor business in 1996. From then, there's been no looking back for Yoon. Under his leadership in October this year, Samsung Smart TV app downloads reached 10 million. They very recently announced a tie up with Google as well and are all set to debut Google TV 2 with their devices over the coming months.

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